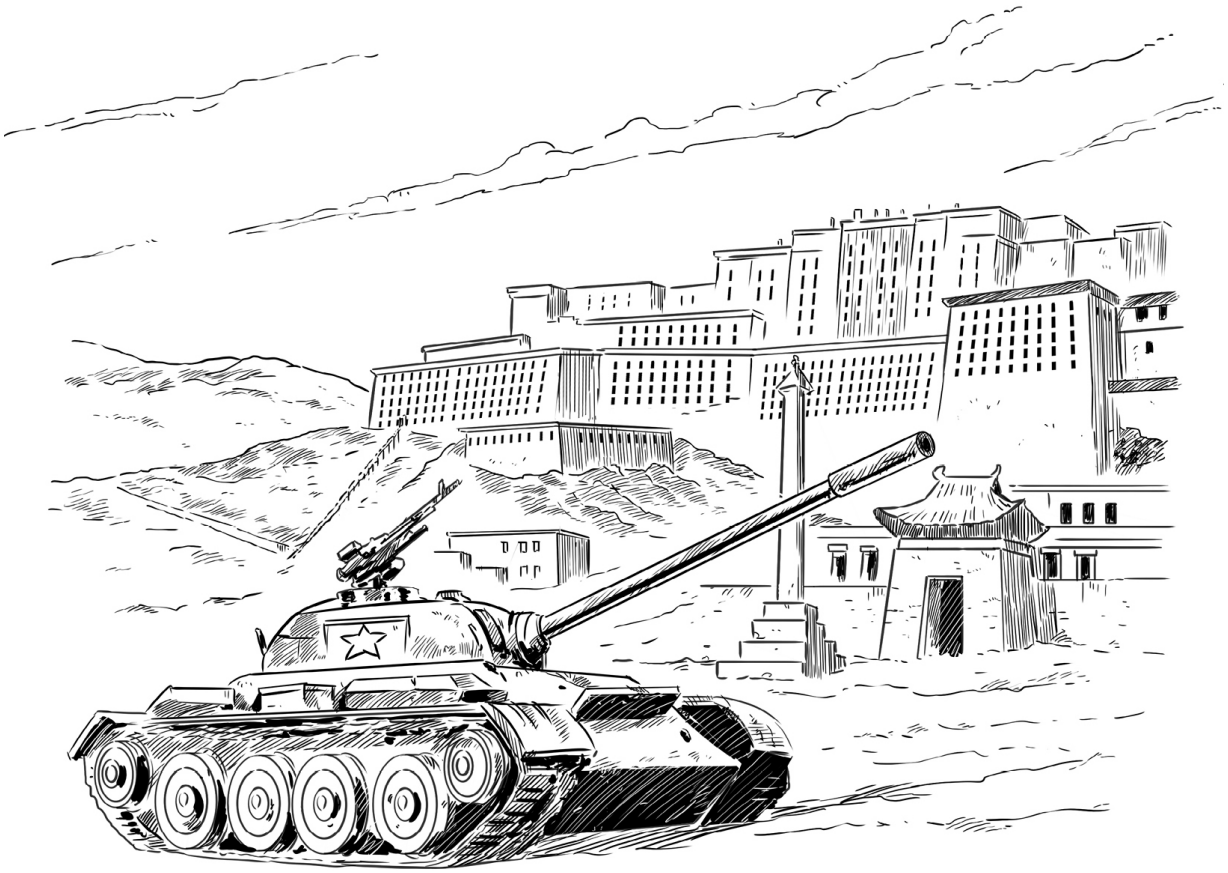


Even though most Tibetans were peaceful people, many started fighting back. This made the Chinese soldiers even more violent. Besides battles on the ground and on horseback, the Chinese bombed eastern areas from the sky. Tibetans fled from the countryside to Lhasa for safety. The population of the capital grew.

In March 1959, when the Dalai Lama was twenty-three, two Chinese soldiers came to visit him at the temple in Lhasa. They invited him to a performance at the Chinese army's headquarters on March 10. They told him he had to come alone. He couldn't bring any Tibetan soldiers or bodyguards with him. The Dalai Lama planned to go to the performance, but many of his advisors wondered if it was a trap. Without soldiers or bodyguards with him, the Dalai Lama could be kidnapped, or worse.